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E2 Speaking & Listening – Exam Prep Lesson 6: Likes, reasons and comparing – Lesson plan and answers

Learners finish able to say how much they like something, give a reason, and compare two things. Task 1 asks about likes and dislikes, and the Task 4 discussion needs opinions with reasons.

Materials: Handout E2-6A, one per learner. Choice cards from the handout cut up, one set per group of three. Six signs for the wall: *I love, I really like, I like, I don't mind, I don't like, I hate*.

Activity 1: How much? (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Put the six signs along one wall in order, from *I love* to *I hate*. Say each one with feeling and have the class repeat.
2. Call out a topic: "Cooking." Learners walk to the sign that is true for them. Ask three learners to say the full sentence: "I really like cooking." Board the pattern: *like + verb + -ing*.
3. Repeat with eight topics: *shopping, getting up early, travelling by bus, cleaning, walking, watching football, rain, studying English*.
4. While learners are standing in groups, they ask the person next to them "Why?" and answer with one reason.
5. Back at desks, learners put the six phrases in order in section A of the handout. Teach *I don't mind* carefully with a gesture: it is not good and not bad. It is the phrase most learners lack.

Activity 2: Because it's… (20 minutes)

1. Ask why someone likes the market. Collect reasons. Board them as *because it's* plus an adjective: *cheap, fresh, friendly*.
2. Build two banks on the board, positive and negative: *cheap, relaxing, healthy, tasty, interesting, quick* and *boring, noisy, expensive, crowded, tiring, slow*. Drill the stress in *relaxing, expensive, interesting*.
3. Chain drill. You say a topic; the first learner says a sentence with a reason; the next learner agrees or disagrees: "Me too" or "Really? I don't."
4. Pairs tell each other three things they like and three they do not, each with a reason. The partner reports one back to the class.

Activity 3: Comparing (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Hold up two real things, or name two: the bus and the train. Ask which is cheaper, faster, more comfortable. Board the answers: *The bus is cheaper than the train. The train is more comfortable than the bus.*
2. Elicit the pattern: short words add *-er*; long words take *more*; *good* and *bad* change to *better* and *worse*.
3. Learners complete section B of the handout alone and check in pairs.
4. Teach *I prefer … to … because …* Drill with three pairs of things.
5. Pairs make four comparing sentences about London and another place they know. Hear one from each pair.

Activity 4: Which one? (25 minutes)

1. Groups of three with the choice cards face down.
2. A learner turns over a card, for example *tea or coffee*, and asks the group: "Which do you prefer?" Each person answers with *I prefer* and a comparing reason.
3. The learner who asked must then say who they agree with and why.
4. Monitor and note good language as well as errors.
5. Feedback: write three good sentences you heard on the board and say who said them. Then two errors, without names, for the class to correct.

Activity 5: Task 1 with likes and dislikes (25 minutes)

1. Remind learners how Task 1 works: they ask each other, then the assessor asks more.
2. In threes: two candidates and one assessor. Candidates ask each other four questions about likes and dislikes, each answer with a reason.
3. The assessor then asks each candidate one comparing question from section D of the handout.
4. The assessor gives one point of praise and one target. Rotate until everyone has been a candidate.
5. Close: each learner says one sentence with *I don't mind* to their partner.

Answer key, Lesson 6

- **Section A:** I love 1, I really like 2, I like 3, I don't mind 4, I don't like 5, I hate 6.
- **Section B:** cheaper, quieter, bigger, busier, easier; more expensive, more relaxing, more interesting, better, worse.